[METRIC]
A-A-723C
April 12, 1995
Superseding
A-A-723B
July 25, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PENCIL, MECHANICAL
FOR 0.5 AND 0.7 MM LEAD SIZES
(Top / Side Activated)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description by all federal agencies.

1. **Scope:** This Commercial Item Description covers refillable mechanical pencils which accommodate 0.5mm and 0.7mm lead sizes.

2. **Classification:**

Types:	1 - Type I - Pencil, Mechanical **(Top Activated)**
	2 - Type II - Pencil, Mechanical **(Side Activated)**
Size:	A - 0.5mm
	B - 0.7mm

3. **Salient Characteristics:**

3.1 Mechanical pencils shall consist of a removable metal or plastic nose, extended fixed, partial retractable, or fully retractable **(sliding)** sleeve **(as applicable)**, a barrel which contains a lead holding device **(clutch mechanism)** and spare lead chamber, metal pocket clip and a replaceable eraser with protective cap.

3.2 Mechanical pencils shall operate by a lead holding device which shall operate by push button action, as indicated in paragraph 3.2.1 and 3.2.2 to propel the lead in short, uniform increments to a usable length from the sleeve end, and shall operate smoothly and easily, without binding, bending, breaking or other malfunctions.

3.2.1 Type I mechanical pencils shall have the clutch mechanism activated by pressing the push button located at the top **(eraser end)** of the pencil.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release;
Distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7520

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3.2.2 Type II mechanical pencils shall have the clutch mechanism activated by pressing the push button located on the side of the barrel near the point of the pencil.

3.3 The lead holding device **(clutch)** shall grip the lead firmly, without breaking, so that the lead does not turn or slip into or out of the holder. The pencil shall be capable of dispensing the specified lead size.

3.4 Leads shall not fall free from the lead holder when the advancement mechanism is activated such that the lead when reduced to a length of as small as 16mm **(5/8 inch)** with sleeve extended will continue to be retained in the mechanical pencil.

3.5 Spare lead shall feed automatically as the lead advancement mechanism is activated. Each pencil shall be furnished with a minimum of three leads of HB hardness. The leads shall be at lease 60mm in length with a ± 2mm in length tolerance.

3.6 The pencil shall have a replaceable eraser eraser where the pencil is specifically designed to accommodate replacement of lead refills. Alternately, disposable mechanical pencils shall be fitted with a non-replaceable eraser. Erasers shall be in accordance with Commercial Item Description A-A-132 and shall be a pencil type suitable for cleanly erasing lead markings without crumbling or breaking.

3.7 The nose **(tip)** shall be removable without the aid of special tools.

3.8 Workmanship. Lead holders shall be securely assembled so that parts do not become loose or displaced and shall be free from defects or imperfections which may adversely affect appearance or serviceability.

4. Regulatory Requirements:

"The offerer / contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation **(FAR)**.

4.1 Toxicity. Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed.Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the pencil conforms to the above requirements.

4.2 Material Safety Data Sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of the manual.

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5. Quality Assurance Requirements:

5.1 Contractors Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2 Responsibility For Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

5.3 Lot Definition. The lot shall consist of all pencils of the same type, and size as offered for delivery at one time.

5.4 Examination and Testing. Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. Statistical Process Controls). These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in the applicable technical document or, herein. For those product characteristics which are controlled by such a method, requirements for end item inspection or test may be considered to have been met. End item inspection / testing may be used by the offeror, or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the inprocess quality controls. Inprocess controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing, unless it can be demonstrated that there exists a direct correlation between the process control and product performance, such that end item performance testing is obviated.

For those characteristics for which there are not such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection / test shall be required. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4 - 1933, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes. For Visual and Dimensional inspections the level shall be S-2 with a (AQL) of 4.0 Defects Per Hundred Units (DPHU). For the purpose of sampling, pencils or components of the same type and size shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examination and testing. For visual or dimensional examination a sample unit shall be one pencil and its components.

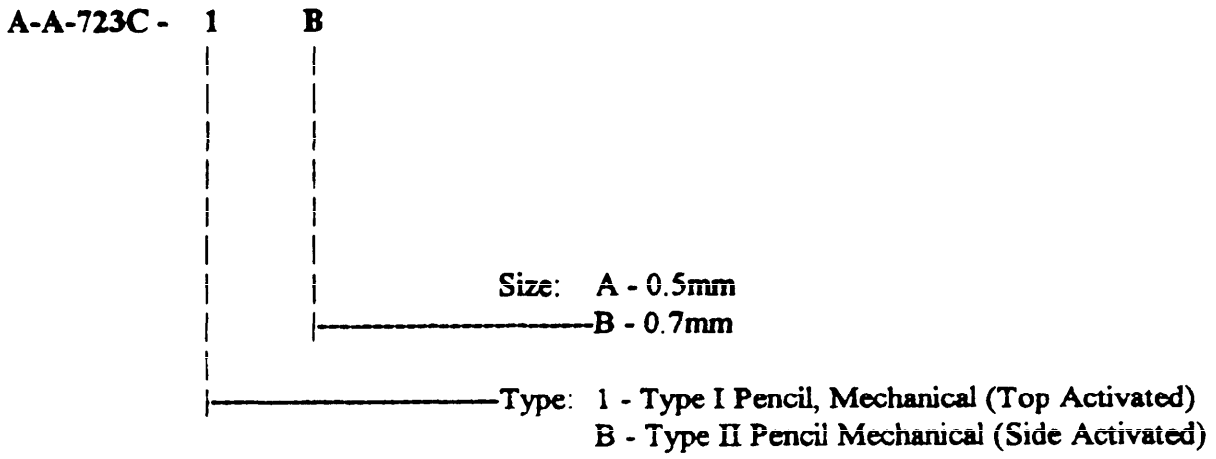
6. Packaging: Preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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7. **Notes:**

7.1 Part Identification Number (PIN). The following part identification numbering procedure is for government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

This example describes a part numbering system for CID A-A-723C:



7.1 Applicable Documents. The following documents, of the issues on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington DC 20402.

7.1.2 ANSI / ASQC Z1.4 - may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control, PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, Wisconsin 53201-4606.

7.2 Ordering Information. Purchasers shall select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall specify the type, and size, as required (See Classification).
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and facilities if other than specified.
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment
E. Purchasers shall specify identification marking, if other than required.
F. Purchasers shall specify if bar coding is not required.
G. Purchasers shall specify palletization, if required.
H. Purchasers shall specify if MSD's are required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.

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7.3 National Stock Number Listing:

Top Activated

7520-00-590-1878
7520-01-132-4996
7520-00-285-5818

Side Activated

7520-01-385-7363
7520-01-386-1581

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE:
DoD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this Commercial Item Description.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS

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